

MAXSQUASH

Tournament Module - API Requirements

Version 1.2

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Audience	Backend Team
Document Scope	Tournament creation, invitations, eligibility, team selection, registration, notifications, and history

Standalone Scope Document

1. Objective

Define the backend API requirements for tournament creation and participation in MaxSquash. This document covers two tournament types, club invitations, acceptance workflows, player eligibility, roster submission, capacity enforcement, deadlines, notifications, and historical records.

2. Tournament Types

Tournament Type	Visibility	Purpose
Club to Club Tournament	Selected clubs and their related users	Competition between clubs
Club Members Only Tournament	Approved members of the organizing club	Internal tournament for club members

3. Tournament Creation

Endpoint: POST /club/tournaments

The club must select the tournament type while creating a tournament. The following fields must be accepted in the request:

- `tournament_type`: CLUB_TO_CLUB or CLUB_MEMBERS_ONLY
- `opponent_club_id`: required only for CLUB_TO_CLUB
- `gender`: MALE, FEMALE, MIXED, or OPEN
- `player_level`: one or more supported levels
- `age_group`: a single inclusive age range in MIN-MAX format, for example 15-25
- `registration_deadline`: final date and time for registration or team submission
- `maximum_players`: maximum number of players allowed
- `name`, `description`, `venue`, `start date`, `end date`, and any other existing tournament fields

```
{
  "tournament_type": "CLUB_TO_CLUB",
  "opponent_club_id": 42,
  "gender": "MALE",
  "player_level": ["INTERMEDIATE", "ADVANCED"],
  "age_group": "15-25",
  "registration_deadline": "2026-08-15T18:00:00Z",
  "maximum_players": 10
}
```

4. Club to Club Tournament Flow

1. Organizing club creates a CLUB_TO_CLUB tournament and selects the opponent club.
2. The system creates an invitation with status PENDING and sends a notification to the selected club.
3. The invited club can accept or reject the invitation.
4. On rejection, the organizing club receives a notification and the rejection is recorded in both clubs tournament history.
5. On acceptance, the invitation moves to SOFT_ACCEPTED until the invited club selects and submits its team.

6. Only after the team is submitted should the invitation become ACCEPTED or CONFIRMED.
7. Both clubs must be able to view the final selected players for the tournament.

5. Invitation Decision API

Recommended endpoint: PATCH /club/tournaments/{tournament_id}/invitation

```
{
  "decision": "ACCEPT"
}
```

Allowed decisions: ACCEPT or REJECT. The backend must verify that the authenticated club is the invited club.

6. Eligible Players for Club to Club Tournament

After the invited club soft-accepts the tournament, a new paginated GET endpoint must return only players who satisfy all tournament criteria and are approved members of the invited club.

Recommended endpoint: GET /club/tournaments/{tournament_id}/eligible-players?page=1&limit=20&search=

- Player must be an approved member of the invited club.
- Player gender must match the tournament gender rule.
- Player level must match an allowed level.
- Player age must fall within the configured inclusive age range. The API must accept one range string only, using MIN-MAX format such as 15-25.
- Player must not be blocked, inactive, removed, or otherwise ineligible.
- Response should include player ID, full name, profile image, membership number, gender, date of birth or age, level, and membership status.
- Pagination metadata should include page, limit, total_items, total_pages, has_next, and has_previous.

7. Team Submission

Recommended endpoint: POST /club/tournaments/{tournament_id}/team

```
{
  "player_ids": [101, 102, 103, 104]
}
```

- Only the invited club can submit its team for a club-to-club tournament.
- Every submitted player must be returned by the eligibility rules at submission time.
- The number of selected players must not exceed maximum_players.
- Submission must be rejected after registration_deadline.
- After successful submission, the invitation becomes ACCEPTED or CONFIRMED.
- The organizing club receives the submitted roster.
- The invited club can also view its submitted roster and tournament status.

8. Club Members Only Tournament Flow

- Only approved members of the organizing club can see the tournament.

- The tournament is shown only to members who match the gender, player level, and configured inclusive age range criteria.
- Eligible players can accept or reject participation.
- Every player decision must be stored in tournament history.
- Accepted players count toward maximum_players.
- Once maximum_players is reached, additional accept attempts must be rejected.
- No player can register after registration_deadline.

9. Player Participation API

Recommended endpoint: PATCH /tournaments/{tournament_id}/participation

```
{
  "decision": "ACCEPT"
}
```

The backend must verify that the player is an approved member of the organizing club and currently matches all eligibility criteria.

10. Tournament Visibility API

Recommended endpoint: GET /tournaments?page=1&limit=20&status=OPEN

- Players should only receive tournaments they are authorized and eligible to view.
- Club-to-club tournaments should be visible to the organizing club, invited club, and their authorized users as required.
- Club-members-only tournaments should only be visible to matching approved members of the organizing club.
- List responses must support pagination and optional filters such as status, tournament type, date, and search.

11. Status Model

Status	Meaning
PENDING	Invitation sent; no decision yet.
SOFT_ACCEPTED	Invited club accepted but has not submitted its team.
ACCEPTED / CONFIRMED	Required team or player registration has been successfully completed.
REJECTED	Invitation or participation request was rejected.
CLOSED	Deadline passed or capacity reached.
CANCELLED	Tournament was cancelled by an authorized club.

12. Notifications

- Send notification to the invited club when a club-to-club tournament invitation is created.
- Send notification to the organizing club when the invitation is accepted, soft-accepted, rejected, or the team is submitted.
- Send notification to eligible club members when a members-only tournament becomes available.
- Send notification to the player after their participation decision is recorded.

- Notifications should contain tournament ID, tournament name, action type, sender club, current status, and a deep-link reference where supported.

13. Tournament History and Audit Trail

- Maintain separate history views for each participating club.
- Store invitation creation, accept/reject action, soft acceptance, team submission, roster updates, player participation decisions, capacity closure, deadline closure, and cancellation.
- Each record should include action, actor type, actor ID, previous status, new status, timestamp, and optional reason.
- History must not be deleted when a tournament is rejected or cancelled.

14. Validation and Business Rules

- `opponent_club_id` is mandatory for `CLUB_TO_CLUB` and must not equal the organizing club ID.
- `opponent_club_id` must be omitted or ignored for `CLUB_MEMBERS_ONLY`.
- `registration_deadline` must be before the tournament start time.
- `maximum_players` must be a positive integer.
- No registration or team submission is allowed after the deadline.
- No registration or team submission may exceed `maximum_players`.
- The same player cannot be added twice to the same tournament roster.
- Eligibility must be revalidated at the moment of acceptance or team submission.
- Concurrent requests must be handled atomically to prevent overbooking beyond capacity.
- A club-to-club invitation remains `SOFT_ACCEPTED` until a valid team is submitted.

15. Standard API Response and Errors

Use the project standard response envelope. Recommended error codes include:

HTTP	Code	Use Case
400	VALIDATION_ERROR	Missing or invalid tournament criteria.
403	FORBIDDEN	Club or player is not authorized for the action.
404	NOT_FOUND	Tournament, club, invitation, or player was not found.
409	CAPACITY_REACHED	Maximum player capacity has been reached.
409	ALREADY_RESPONDED	Invitation or participation decision already finalized.
410	REGISTRATION_CLOSED	Registration deadline has passed.
422	PLAYER_NOT_ELIGIBLE	Player does not satisfy membership or criteria rules.

16. Acceptance Criteria

- A club can create either supported tournament type with all required criteria.
- A club-to-club invitation is created as `PENDING` and notifies the invited club.
- Rejecting an invitation notifies the organizer and creates history for both clubs.
- Accepting an invitation keeps it `SOFT_ACCEPTED` until a valid team is submitted.

- Eligible-player API returns only approved members matching all criteria and supports pagination.
- Team submission respects eligibility, deadline, duplicate, authorization, and capacity rules.
- Members-only tournaments are visible only to eligible approved club members.
- Players can accept or reject members-only participation and their decisions are recorded.
- The system prevents the 11th registration when maximum_players is 10, including concurrent requests.
- Both clubs can view the final roster for an accepted club-to-club tournament.